

Obsession or Stubbornness?

From one pothole to a reporting platform for every Canadian city. And why the caring mattered far more than the code.

Eight months. One pothole.

Then a 12-minute form, five pages, a reference number, and a status page that never changed. That is where most people quit. The cost of caring got higher than the value of caring.

Cupholders.

Volkswagen's engineers refused them for years. The car was a temple, not a coffee table. A hundred rational decisions, one human blind spot.

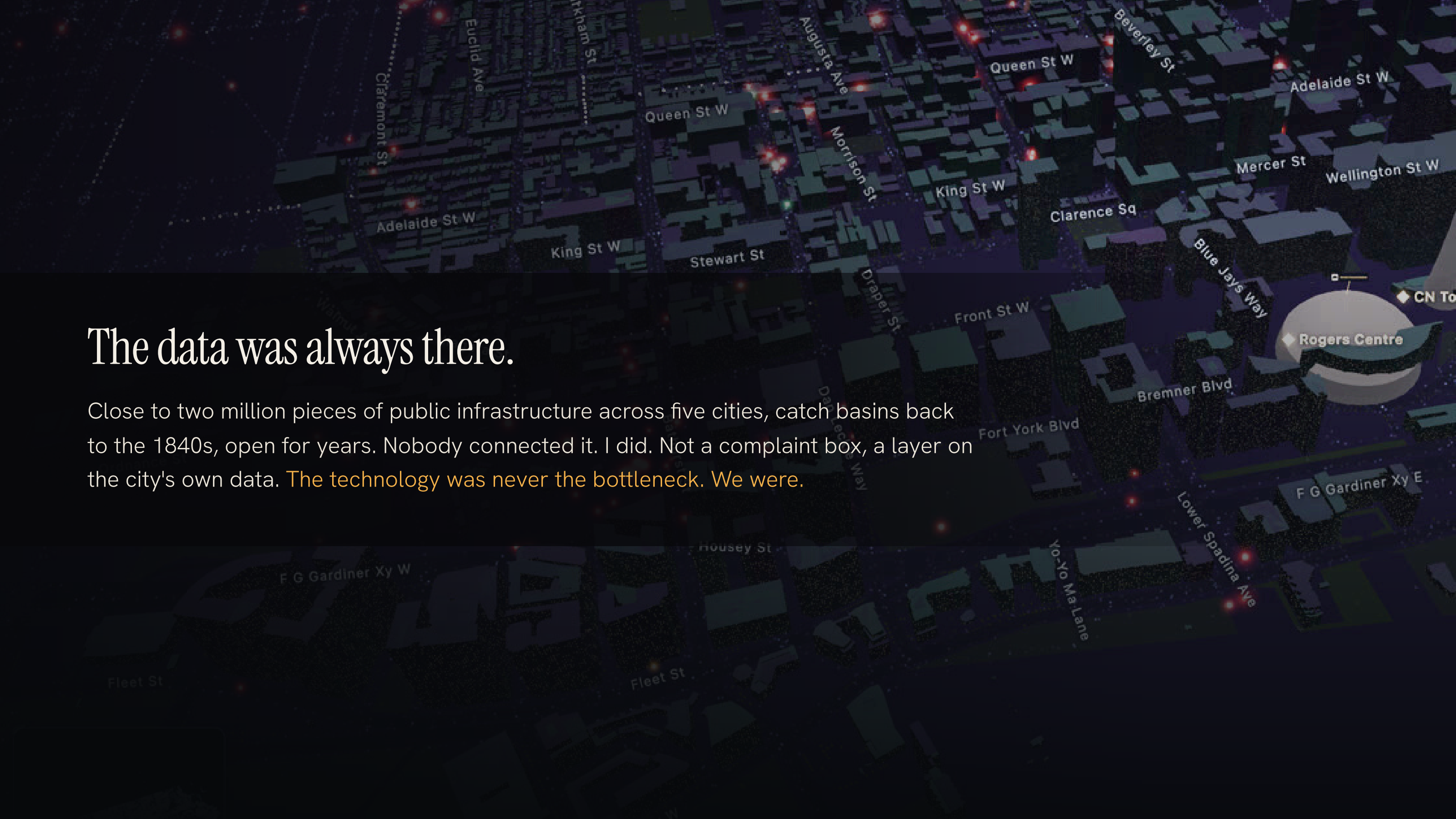
This is not about me.

My only specialty is refusing to walk past a problem. This time a pothole. Next time something else.

And it's not just me. [Close to a thousand reports across five cities.](#) People came back.

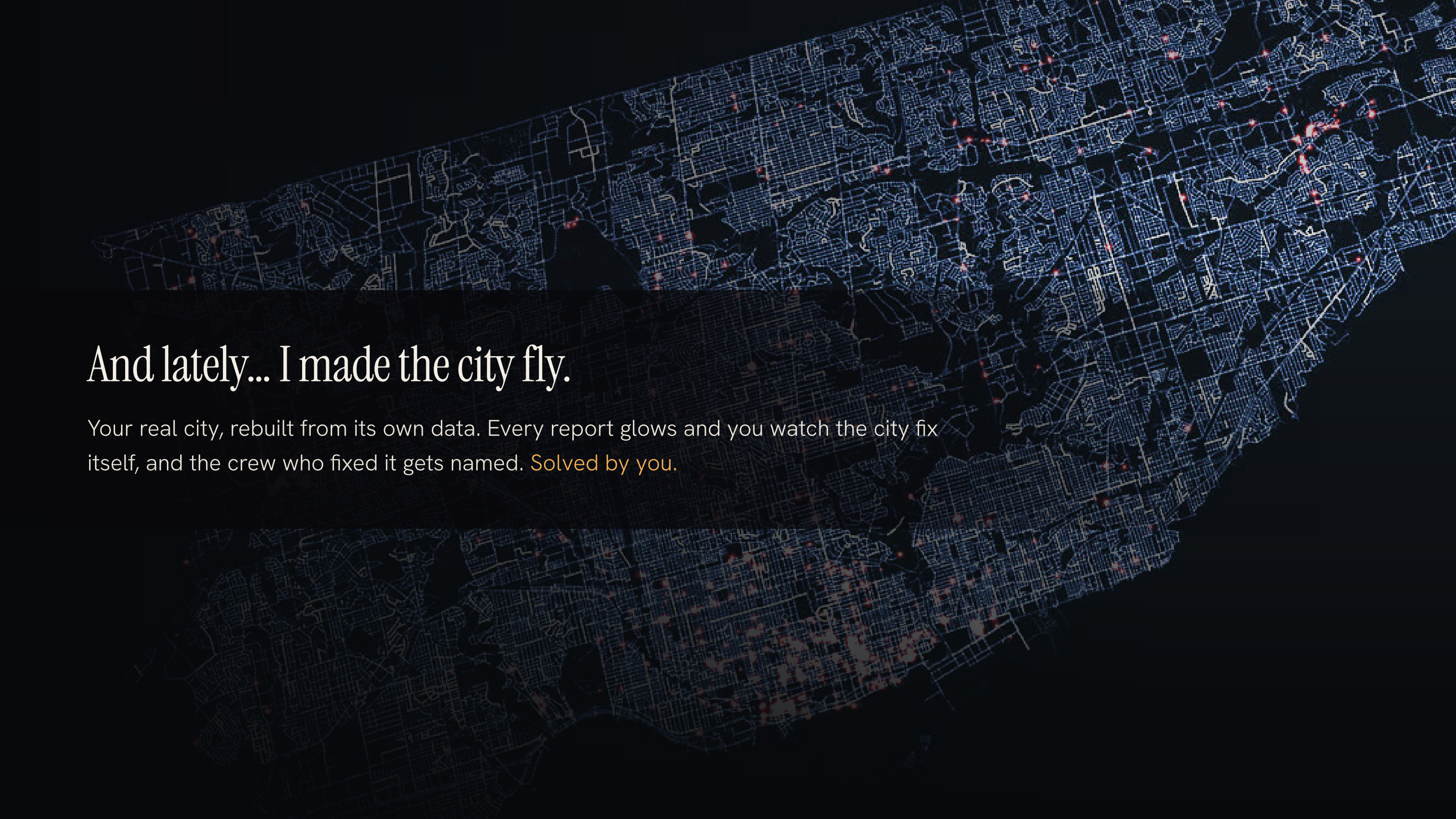
One photo. Or five words.

Thirty seconds, and it's on its way to the city and your councillor. **Make not using it feel stupider than using it.**

An aerial, isometric view of a city street grid at night. The streets are dark, and the buildings are represented by dark, blocky shapes. Numerous small, glowing red dots are scattered across the grid, representing data points. Some street names are visible, such as Queen St W, King St W, Adelaide St W, and Front St W. On the right side, a large, white, dome-shaped structure is labeled 'Rogers Centre'. Other labels include 'CN Tower', 'Bremner Blvd', 'Fort York Blvd', 'Lower Spadina Ave', 'F G Gardiner Xy E', 'Fleet St', 'Housey St', 'Dan Leckie Way', 'Blue Jays Way', 'Wellington St W', 'Mercer St', 'Adelaide St W', 'Beverley St', 'Augusta Ave', 'Morrison St', 'Stewart St', 'King St W', 'Adelaide St W', 'Euclid Ave', 'Clarendon St', and 'Fleet St'.

The data was always there.

Close to two million pieces of public infrastructure across five cities, catch basins back to the 1840s, open for years. Nobody connected it. I did. Not a complaint box, a layer on the city's own data. *The technology was never the bottleneck. We were.*



And lately... I made the city fly.

Your real city, rebuilt from its own data. Every report glows and you watch the city fix itself, and the crew who fixed it gets named. **Solved by you.**

Now look around this room.

A campus like this one is a small town. So is a hospital, a business district, a building you run. If you can draw it on a map, it can be live in a week.

Solve Canada

The fifth city is a Tuesday afternoon.

I used to say that as a promise. Last week it happened. I launched two more cities in a single afternoon. This is [SolveCanada](#), one platform, every city on one map. Not a money problem, not a talent problem, an architecture problem, which means a choice.

[SolveTO](#)[SolveSAUGA](#)[SolveMILTON](#)[SolveKITCHENER](#)[SolveWATERLOO](#)

It was never the technology.

*“Unless someone like you
cares a whole awful lot,
nothing is going to get better.
It’s not.”*

DR. SEUSS · THE LORAX

*“We are here.
We are here.
We are here!”*

DR. SEUSS · HORTON HEARS A WHO

Obsession or Stubbornness?

Both.

I'm not asking permission. I'm building it now. The only question is who moves with me.

Thank you.



SCAN TO TAKE THE TALK WITH YOU

Ahmed Nadar

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Find me in the breakouts, or reach out anytime.

I build software for people who refuse to walk past a problem.

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